

AN MD STUDIO GUIDE

Writing in Plain Text

A practical guide to writing in Markdown with MD Studio.

Dann Bleeker Pedersen

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Foreword

Draft outline. This chapter is planned, not yet written. The bullets below are the ground it will cover.

- Why another Markdown editor: two views on one document, and files that stay yours.
- Who the book is for: people who write notes, docs and drafts and want them to outlive any app.
- How the book is organized: chapters 1–6 cover the tool, chapter 7 the practice.

Your First Document

Opening, creating, saving, installing

Draft outline. This chapter is planned, not yet written. The bullets below are the ground it will cover.

- The start screen: continue, new, open, recent.
- Creating a document and giving it a name on first save.
- Opening an existing `.md` file: the file picker, drag and drop, and (on Windows) double-click once installed.
- Saving back to the same file versus Save as; what happens in browsers without file access (downloads).
- Installing MD Studio as an app on Windows, macOS and phones; how updates arrive.

Anatomy of the Editor

The split view, the two panes, and what “synced” means

Draft outline. This chapter is planned, not yet written. The bullets below are the ground it will cover.

- The toolbar: file name and the unsaved-changes dot, file actions, view modes, linked scroll.
- The text pane: Markdown as written, with syntax highlighting.
- The visual pane: the same document, formatted, and editable directly.
- What “synced” actually means: one document, two views; edits travel within a fraction of a second, both ways.
- Why a visual edit can tidy formatting elsewhere in the source, and when that matters.
- Linked scroll: why it follows headings instead of pixels.
- The command palette and settings.

Structuring Documents

Headings, lists, sections — keeping a document navigable as it grows

Draft outline. This chapter is planned, not yet written. The bullets below are the ground it will cover.

- Heading levels as an outline: one H1, sections as H2, rarely deeper than H3.
- Lists: bullets for sets, numbers for sequences, task lists for to-dos.
- Sections that can be moved as units, and headings that double as scroll anchors.
- Signs a document has outgrown its structure, and how to split it.

Formatting and Rich Content

Links, images, tables, code blocks, footnotes

Draft outline. This chapter is planned, not yet written. The bullets below are the ground it will cover.

- Emphasis, links and inline code, in both panes.
- Images: referencing files next to the document versus web URLs.
- Tables: when they help, and how they read in plain text.
- Fenced code blocks and language hints.
- Footnotes and block quotes; what is CommonMark and what is GitHub Flavored Markdown.

Managing Files Locally

File access on Windows, local persistence, working across devices

Draft outline. This chapter is planned, not yet written. The bullets below are the ground it will cover.

- Where your document lives: on disk, and in the browser as a safety net.
- The File System Access API on Windows and Chromium browsers: what permission you grant, and why Save writes in place.
- What “local-first” means here: no account, no server, no sync service.
- Moving between devices with tools you already have: OneDrive, Dropbox, git.
- Recovering from a closed tab or a crash.

Exporting and Sharing

Export formats; what travels well and what doesn't

Draft outline. This chapter is planned, not yet written. The bullets below are the ground it will cover.

- Sharing the `.md` file itself, which is often the best format.
- Export to HTML; printing to PDF.
- What survives the trip: headings, lists, tables; and what may not: relative image paths, extended syntax.
- Pasting into email, chat and wikis.

Writing as Practice

Plain text as a discipline, not a limitation

Draft outline. This chapter is planned, not yet written. The bullets below are the ground it will cover.

- Plain text as a feature: files that stay readable, portable and durable long after any particular app is gone.
- When to reach for structure (headings, lists) and when to just write prose and let structure emerge later.
- Plain text and version control: why Markdown pairs naturally with git, and how that changes the way you treat drafts and revisions.
- Two lenses on the same thinking: switching between the visual and raw views to check your own structure, not just for formatting.

Appendix A — Keyboard Reference

Draft outline. This chapter is planned, not yet written. The bullets below are the ground it will cover.

- Every shortcut, grouped by file, view, palette and editing; mirrors USER_GUIDE.md.

Appendix B — Markdown Syntax Reference

Draft outline. This chapter is planned, not yet written. The bullets below are the ground it will cover.

- CommonMark essentials with side-by-side source and rendered examples.
- GitHub Flavored Markdown extensions: tables, task lists, strikethrough, autolinks.

Appendix C — Further Reading

Draft outline. This chapter is planned, not yet written. The bullets below are the ground it will cover.

- The CommonMark specification and the GFM specification.
- John Gruber’s original Markdown syntax page.
- Writing about plain-text workflows and version control for prose.